African Sun

October 1992

Quote of the Month

"Oratory is the cunning of the tongue over the ear, but eloquence is the joining of the heart with the soul."

—Kahlil Gibran

HISTORICAL EVENTS—OCTOBER

— 1966—The Black Panther Party is founded in Oakland, CA by Huey Newton and Bobby Seale.

1, 1960—Nigeria proclaims its independence from Great Britain.

2-4, 1935—Italy invades Ethiopia. African-Americans hold mass meetings of protest and raise funds for the Ethiopian defenders.

3, 1974—Frank Robinson is named manager of the Cleveland Indians. He is the first Black manager in Major League history.

8, 1967— Bob Gibson of the St. Louis Cardinals becomes the first Black pitcher to post a shutout in the World Series against the Boston Red Sox.

14, 1964—Martin Luther King, Jr., 35, becomes the youngest man ever to win the Nobel Peace Prize.

16, 1968—John Carlos and Tommie Smith stage a Black Power demonstration at the Olympics in Mexico City, following their first and third place finishes in the 200m dash. Their black-gloved salute was a symbolic protest against racism in the U.S.

22, 1963—Over 225,000 students boycott Chicago schools in the Freedom Day protest of de facto segregation.

30, 1954—The U.S. Defense Department announces the elimination of all segregated regiments in the armed forces.

30, 1974—Muhammad Ali triumphs over George Foreman in Zaire for the Heavyweight Boxing Championship.

Sources: " A Hard Road to Glory"— Aetna's 1991 Calendar of African-American History ; Before the Mayflower, Lerone Bennett, Jr.

Updated List of Contacts for Black Student Organizations

African Students Association	Bidemi Carrol	x4563
Alpha Kappa Alpha Sorority, Inc.	Regine Ostine	x6678
Alpha Phi Alpha Fraternity, Inc.	Rahsan Lindsay	x5132
Black Pre-Medical Society	Nicole Brewer	x6419
Black Voices Alafia	Clair Chester	x6523
Brown Sisters United	Angelique Anderson	x4989
Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc.	Nina Guercio	351-1036
Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Inc.	Hardy Bright	x6578
Kulcha Kollectiv	Rod Bowen	x6301
NAACP	Evelyn Wande	x5869
Nat'l Society of Black Engineers	Ayanna MacCalla	x6511
The Next Thing	Ed Brockenbrough	x6179
Omega Psi Phi Fraternity, Inc.		
Onyx	Ayanna MacCalla	x6511
OUAP	Khary Lazarre-White	x4556
Pan-Hellenic Council	Antoinette Blanchette	x6416
Phi Beta Sigma Fraternity, Inc.	Bruce Strothers	x6164
Psychology Students of Color		
Shades of Brown	Nicole Brewer	x6419
Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority. Inc.	Antoinette Blanchette	x6416
Students of Carribean Ancestry	Michelle Drysdale	x4799
Third World Pre-Business Society	David Hirsch	453-4923
Third World Pre-Law Society	Neneh Mybe	x5324
Voices of Inspiration	Heather Grady	x6417
Women of Color Collective	Dawn Adams	x4989
Zeta Phi Beta Sorority, Inc.	Yulisa Cruz	x5008

All Black student organizations are welcome to advertise upcoming events in the **Calendar of Events** section of the *African Sun*. To do so, contact J. Omari Johnson, x6206, by October 28. This means you, no C.P.T. please!

AFRICAN NEWS

Hope for Somalia

In an effort to beat the rains due within the next several weeks, the International Committee of the Red Cross is distributing more than 1,000 tons of seeds across the famine zone of Somalia. Food troubles in Somalia, due partially to armed clan-based conflict, have forced many farmers off of the land. Village elders and Red Cross officials hope the news of seed distribution will encourage farmers to return from feeding centers like Baidoa and the capital city, Mogadisha. The Red Cross has also set up relief kitchens around Baidoa in an effort to give farmers the energy to plant and to bring villages back to life. While much of Somalia is in the clutches of famine and death, there is hope that planting seeds will slowly revive the once flourishing agricultural center.

New York Times, September 23, 1992.

Zulu Leader Suspends Peace Talks

Mangosutha Gatsa Buthelezi, leader of the Inkatha Freedom Party, announced that his party would not participate in peace talks in Pretoria scheduled for October 3. The KwaZulu government leader voiced his anger over bilateral negotiations between the African National Congress and the South African government, which resulted in a deal to release over 150 political prisoners. The government also agreed to ban the public display of all cultural and modern weapons, which have been linked to township violence. Buthelezi stated at a township rally in KwaMusa that the Zulus should not need permission to carry Zulu cultural weapons, usually sticks and spears. This issue only fuels the tensions between the ANC and the Inkatha movement that have already cost thousands of lives.

Boston Globe, September 28, 1992.

LATIN AMERICAN NEWS

Peru Sweeps "The Path"

President Alberto Fujimori released a list this past month with names and nick-names of the external connections of "The Shining Path," an Orthodox Communist Movement. The government has set up a special judicial system which prohibits witnesses for those accused and conceals the identity of judges for their protection against possible terrorist retaliation. This system resulted from the recent capture of the group's leader, Abimael Guzman Reyno. Many have compared the present climate in Peru to that of a witch hunt. However, thousands of Peruvians took to the streets last week to celebrate the imprisonment of Reyno.

Collor Caught by the Collar

On September 29, Brazilian president Fernando Collor was impeached by the legislative's lower house in an overwhelming 441 to 38 open-vote majority. Collor was charged with using millions of dollars of federal funds to sustain the extravagant lifestyle of his family and friends. Collor was Brazil's first freely elected leader in over three decades and the first president in the history of Brazil to be impeached.

The Toil for Oil

Britain has authorized inhabitants of the Malvinas (Faukland Islands) to explore oil prospects on the islands. The decision sparked resentment from Argentina's government, which considers the island within its geographical and political domain. British and Argentinian officials are expected to meet in New York to discuss oil rights within the islands.

U. S. NEWS

Barry is Back

Former D.C. mayor, Marion Barry is back. Six months after his release from prison for cocaine possession, he won by a landside (69.5%) in the September 15 Democratic primary for the District City Council for the 8th ward, the city's poorest ward. With the wards overwhelming Democratic constituency, he is virtually assured to win a council seat in the November 3 General Election.

To Serve and Protect?

An 18 year-old man was assaulted by five off-duty police officers in a New York subway. According to eyewitness reports, Yumas Mohammed was walking down the aisle when he was tripped by one of the officers. Words were exchanged and an officer hit Mohammed with a beer bottle. A fight ensued. The other officers then jumped Mohammed and began to beat him savagely. Mohammed is currently in the hospital but in custody awaiting charges for attempted murder. No charges have been brought against the officers.

Amsterdam News, September 26, 1992

CAMPUS NEWS

Black Experience Meeting

On September 28 in Salomon 101, Black students gathered at an organizational meeting for the upcoming "Black Experience at Brown." This weekend of panels, tours, and social events allows Black students from the East Coast to come and take a look at Brown life from an African-American perspective. For more info about how to get involved see **FYI...** on the last page of this issue.

Reaching Out to the Community

On Wednesday, September 23, Brown Community Outreach (BCO) hosted **Volunteer Opportunities Night**. This event had representatives from many of the 120 community-based organizations which work on problems ranging from AIDS and homelessness to community organizing and health care. Although there is a great need for student involvement in the Black and Latino communities of Providence, there was a surprisingly small number of African-American students present. Surely, this number does not reflect the amount of concerned and interested students on campus, so if you would like to get involved, drop by the BCO office downstairs at 25 George St. (near the Rock), or call Olu Gittens at x5991.

Spell # 7

"Voodoo, hoodoo, juju," sang the cast of Ntozake Shange's *Spell #7,* which was presented September 24 through 27 and September 30 through October 4 at Leeds Theater. Under the direction of Elmo Terry-Morgan (Afro-American Studies and Theater, Speech, and Dance), *Spell #7* examined some of the stereotypical identities that have been constructed for Black Americans by white American society. Terry-Morgan's cross-gender and cross-racial casting of roles provided another intriguing dimension to an already complex and insightful play. Congratulations to the cast and crew on a job well done.

The Phenomenal Woman

On the afternoon of Sunday, October 11, the Brown community "went to church." The sermon was titled "Exterior Explorations, Interior Discoveries," and presiding over the pulpit - the remarkable Maya Angelou. Author of such novels as *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings,* Maya's appearance was the culmination of the University's quintcentennial recognition of Columbus's "historical and hysterical" voyage to the Americas. Maya emphasized the need for all Americans to acknowledge the bittersweet past which we have inherited and to create a brighter future

THOUGHTS & OPINIONS

The following are thoughts and opinions of individuals from Brown's Black community. They do not necessarily reflect the views of the *African Sun* or the Organization of United African Peoples. The purpose of Thoughts & Opinions is to stimulate discussion among members of the Black community. Keep this in mind as you read. Enjoy!

Food for Thought

I'm sure that all of you are familiar with Janet Jackson's top- selling single and album titled "Rhythm Nation." The question I put before you is: Are you a part of the Rhythm Nation?

After pondering this question for a day or so, I have concluded that I am not a part of the Rhythm Nation. Historically, African Americans have often bragged about the stereotype, "All Black people have rhythm." I urge you to open your eyes and really see these Moonwalking-Hammerstomping-Cabbage-Patch-working-Humpty-Hump-jerking people realistically. What has happened to the true rhythm of the nation? I mean, how much originality and diversity do you see at the parties around here? Not much. Everybody's bouncing in those same motions that our parents were bouncing to in the 60's when James Brown was sliding across the stage at 20mph instead of five. What IS up?

If we as a collective community are going to take pride in something, it should be something worth taking pride in. It has been my understanding that our rhythm came from taking all types of musical situations and coming up with phenomenal results. What is phenomenal about jumping up and down? Anybody can jump around! Why not add a twist to that jump? It has been the diversity and complexity of our moves that kept other cultures peeking through the cracks of the doors. Now they don't even have to peek, the door is stretched wide open and they just keep right on walking. The musical diversity is here, the rest is up to us. Now, I ask you again... Are YOU a part of the Rhythm Nation? I don't think so. Black people didn't use to play that.

--Ebony L. Lee '96

STD's Are No Joke

Sorry to sound preachy or monotonous, but no one I know seems to be serious about sexually transmitted diseases (STD's) or Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV) in the Black community at Brown. Even though monogamy is the best route to take in order to avoid an STD, some people do not care; they do not think it will happen to them. In fact, infidelity is a game to many people who delight in scratching names off their list or bragging at parties about who they have had and who they will have. That's not funny, it's just plain foolish. Sex has its consequences. Being young, Black adults in an insulated environment at Brown, we do not realize that those consequences may hit us five years from now. All

those people who are laughing at the people they have dissed or cheated on, the joke may soon be on them.

It is appalling to see how lightly sex is taken in the Black community. We are not living in the 70's where free sex orgies are the norm. This is the 90's and some of us (as morbid as this may sound) may not be around by the year 2000. What is it going to take to make us serious? We think that just because we all know each other that none of us can be "nasty". But how many people are really using their condoms all the time, even during oral sex? Sex involves so much these days, but how many people are taking the time to realize physical intimacy does not equal love and could land you with an incurable disease? Anyone who has ever had a sexual partner, even just one, better consider a lot. It's no longer cool to have dozens of sex partners. Selectivity is the name of the game. After all, just think of how many times we have heard of cases where people just had sex once with a person they swore was "clean" only to get HIV fifteen years later.

I am not trying to condemn anyone. What people do in their own rooms is their own business. But come on Black people, wake up. Do you know that by the year 2000 almost half of our community will have perished to AIDS, and some of those corpses may be people we know intimately on this campus. If that does not scare you then maybe you should read up on the present statistics involving Black women and AIDS. Unprotected sex not only endangers you but all of your sexual partners as well. If you are involved in a sexual relationship and you feel the need to seek out additional sexual partners, inform the person you are with. Even though the person may be upset with you, nothing may compare to the shock of realizing that at the tender age of 25 both of you may die because of carelessness and selfishness. All of you out there who are having sex with multiple partners should go and get yourselves tested.

This is not about morals. If you don't protect, you infect. If you play, you pay. Maybe not now, but possibly further down the line. We are supposed to be the future of America, the college-educated group that's going to deliver this nation from its ills. How are we going to do that if we are not here? Black people, we are smarter than that, aren't we?

—Anonymous

Untitled

I was born at a time
when there was fear.
I lived in a place
overflowing with tears.
I was brought into a world
that just did not care.
I was born as a "NIGGA"
wasn't that a scare.

I was born at a time
when most could not see.
I lived in a place
that did not respect me.
I was brought into a world
just not meant for me.
I was born a "Blackman"
no! I can't be free.

I was born at a time
with no reason to live.
I live in a place.....
fated to die.
I was brought into a world
with nothing to give.
I was born, I was born....
i just don't know why.

—Oris T. Bryant '96

Time for Reality

1) One out of every 3 Black men from the age of 20 to 29 will commit murder or be murdered.
2) Black people are 12% of the United States population: we are 41% of the murder victims.
3) The Black infant mortality rate is 17.9%, higher than most Third World nations.
4) AIDS is the leading cause of death of Black women in New York City.
5) Black babies make up more than 60% of the children under 5 with AIDS.
6) Black males are 6% of the U.S. population; we are 46% of the U.S. prison population.
7) The United States imprisons Black males at four times the rate of South Africa.
8) In 1960, 67% of Black children lived with both of their parents. In 1990, 38% of Black children lived with both of their parents.
9) Nearly 50% of all Black children are born into poverty.
10) The median wealth of Black households is 9% of that of white households.

James Baldwin once wrote that, "This innocent country set you down in a ghetto in which, in fact, it intended that you should perish... you were born where you were born and faced the future that you faced because you were black and for no other reason... You were born into a society which spelled out with brutal clarity, and in as many ways as possible, that you were a worthless human being."

Baldwin wrote these words in 1962; as you can see by the preceding statistics, our circumstances have not changed. Our lives are still deemed "worthless," and we are paid, jailed, and killed accordingly. What will we do in our lives to help to change our situation as a people? As Lorraine Hansberry once wrote, Black people "...must concern themselves with every single means of struggle: legal, illegal, passive, active, violent and nonviolent. They must harass, debate, petition, give money to court struggles, sit-in, lie-down, strike, boycott, sing hymns, pray on steps - and shoot from their windows when the racists come cruising through their communities." None of the presidential candidates will alleviate our problems, it is up to us. All Black people must turn our eyes inward, and question our souls. What will each of our respective roles be? Our great-great grandparents were slaves. Our great grandparents struggled through the turn of a new century. Our grandparents dealt with the evil system of Jim Crow and lynching. Our parents fought in the Civil Rights Movement and brought Crow to its knees. We are the first generation born into legal "freedom." Yet, it is our generation that is not surviving. What means of struggle will our generation choose? What path will we follow?

—Khary Lazarre-White '95

Sources for statistics: James H. Cone, Martin & Malcolm & America; Jean Latz Griffin, Chicago Tribune; B. Kantowitz, Newsweek; New York Correctional Association Annual Statistics 1989; William Julius Williams, The Truly Disadvantaged; W.M. Woodward, Black Enterprise.

Prelude to "Upon receiving a letter..."

For centuries, African-Americans have been chastised and ridiculed for their hate and anger of America and the circumstances surrounding being drafted into the armed forces. I say now, that these feelings are justified.

What say those to the centuries of African-American servitude, to the so-called emancipation, and the reenactment of servitude by forcing Blacks to fight for a democracy that, indeed, does not exist. Moreover, upon homecoming, there is neither respect from *Uncle Sam* nor from society. The fact that any person of color is forced to fight for a country that doesn't give unconditional respect to all its people is proof enough of the racism that still exists within governmental policies. Furthermore, as America continues to deny African-Americans of our rights, and the full use of the constitution, we will continue to deny America of our services; we will continue to deny our pledge of allegiance.

Upon receiving a letter...

...What?!

How dare he WANT my service.
After years of our servitude.

Listen...

Raided—Raped.
Hunted—Caged.
Shackled—Chained.
Emancipated?—Drafted.
Segregated—Trained.
Shipped—Killed.

Return home
—"HOME?"—
to a family of ignorance,
ungrateful screams:
"Take off that uniform Nigger!"
—SAM lets this take place.

Please.

Treated like a whore,
—this country?
I'm not dying for.

What can I say to this man?
Make him understand...
...He is not my uncle.

—Vincent DePaul Ferrell II '94

Calendar of Events for October

15—OUAP Finance Committee meeting, Faunce House, rm. 323, 5pm. Call Evelyn, x5869 if interested.

16—Unity Day, sponsored by Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority, Inc. "White Men Can't Jump", Salomon 001, 4-6pm.

—Party co-sponsored by Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority, Inc. and Sigma Lambda Upsilon Sorority, Inc. Alumnae Hall, 10pm-2am, $3.

17—Students of Carribean Ancestry (SOCA) will sponsor a cookout. Place and time TBA.

18—Evening Worship in the Black Tradition will resume services in Manning Chapel at 6:30pm. Rev. William Lee of Beacon Ave Church of God will be delivering the message on interim. He will conduct a weekly male Bible study. Weekly Bible study for women will be conducted by the women's leaders of Voices. For more information, call Heather Grady at x6417. Although our services have finally begun, there still remains the problem of a permanent pastor. We need to show the university that this is a priority.

19—Professor Joseph Harris of Howard University will speak on "Global Diaspora of African Peoples" in Wilson 101, 4pm.

24—Mama Etta's, a jazz/blues cabaret, sponsored by Kulcha Kollectiv. Churchill House, time TBA.

26—Professor Martin Bernal of Cornell University will speak on "The Black Athena Controversy: AfroAsian Roots of Western Civilization"

31—The first OUAP "Each one, Reach one" Weekend. OUAP and BCO will co-sponsor a Halloween party for the youth of Mt. Hope Neighborhood Association's afterschool program. At least 20 people, including a deejay, are needed to help prepare and participate. Then, on Sunday, November 1, a team of 15 people will be needed to work on a one-day project with SWAP, a group which makes homes from abandoned property in South Providence. The projects will be followed by a forum on Black students and community service, time and place TBA. If you're interested, please contact Olu Gittens (x5991) or OUAP community liasons Nadirah Moreland (x6392) and Joelle Murchison (x6271). Get involved!!

F.Y.I. ...

•Gerald Taylor and Terrence Taylor both work in Career Services, Pembroke Hall, 1st Floor. Gerald staffs the office Tuesdays and Thursdays, 11-1 and Terrence staffs Wednesdays, 11-3. Career services offers invaluable information concerning resumé writing techniques, internships, full-time jobs, recruiting and alumni contacts.

•Black Experience at Brown still needs you. There is a definite need for Black students, particularly males, to house prospectives for this event. Also needed are people to give tours and to sit on the senior panel. For more information or to sign up to volunteer, contact Michele Pierre-Louis x6154

•Quaker Oats will hold a luncheon for students of color interested in Marketing/Brand Management, Nov. 12, TWC, 12pm. A general info. session will take place at 8pm in the Crystal Room.

•Jeanne Smith, Program Coordinator of the Third Word Center will be retiring on October 30. For many years now, she has been the glue that held the TWC together. She will be missed. A reception is tentatively scheduled for October 28, 4-6pm.

•Deadline for submissions for the November *African Sun* is October 28. For more info call Ed x6179 or Milda x4575.

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